COMMITTEE 1 (LETTER POST)

World Association for the Development of Philately Management Committee

First World Association for the Development of Philately Management Committee meeting of the 2009–2012 cycle (Berne, 4 November 2008, from 3 to 6 p.m.), Abubakar Argungu room

Philately development plan for the 2009–2012 cycle

(Agenda item 2)

I. Introduction

1 The 24th UPU Congress, which took place in Geneva from 23 July to 13 August 2008, voted on several resolutions and proposals concerning philately:

– resolution C 36/2008 which sets out the work to be carried out by the Postal Operations Council during the period 2009–2012;

– resolution C 26/2008 which updates the code of ethics for postage stamp issues;

– the revision of article 8 of the Universal Postal Union Convention, which defines the status of the postage stamp.

2 These texts should serve as a guide for defining the philately development plan for the coming cycle, which will cover the period from 2009 to 2012.

II. General remarks

3 The development of philately is included in programmes 4.1.7, 4.3.3 and 4.4.5 of the Nairobi Strategy. In resolution C 36/2008, the Geneva Congress recognized the importance of philately to UPU member countries and the significant source of revenue it represents. It voted specifically that the development of philately should be an important part of Posts' activities and provide appreciable support for Posts and for postal development in general.

4 Congress decision C 26/2008 is also based on the fact that postage stamps:

– represent a specific brand image distinguishing the postal service from private-sector delivery services;

– continue to serve as ambassadors for countries and their postal services, both nationally and internationally.

5 The adoption of resolution C 36/2008 defines the main areas of the philately development plan for 2009–2012, thus providing a roadmap for achieving the objectives of the POC, through concrete initiatives implemented by means of the activities of the World Association for the Development of Philately (WADP), as set out by Congress:

– to pursue dialogue with partners in the philatelic sector and to coordinate philatelic development activities;

– to continue its work on determining the most effective and efficient means of informing the members and the philatelic industry of postage stamps officially issued by issuing postal authorities;

– to continue to promote the application of best practices and sound business principles in the philatelic sector through targeted activities and training;

– to pursue the implementation of training programmes for issuing postal authorities, including innovation, techniques for developing the philatelic market, the use of new technologies and improved security techniques for the issue of postage stamps;

– to consider ways of creating a model database for the online sale of postage stamps for developing and least developed countries;

– to define a joint strategy with the International Federation of Philately (FIP) to help issuing postal authorities to implement programmes aimed specifically at young people;

– to implement a strategy encouraging UPU member countries to include in their annual philatelic programmes global themes requested by United Nations agencies;

– to define a flexible and consistent policy within the framework of the philately development plan, so as to preserve the unique characteristics of the postage stamp, protecting its intrinsic collector value and attributes that distinguish it from other forms of postal prepayment;

– to adopt flexible and innovative approaches to the marketing positioning of philatelic products, in keeping with the unique profile of the postage stamp as the core philatelic product.

III. Reconstitution of the WADP and its Management Committee

6 The aim of the WADP is to develop and promote philately through ongoing positive dialogue between philatelic industry partners (AIJP, IFSDA, ASCAT, INTERGRAF and FIP) and issuing postal authorities, in both industrialized and developing countries.

7 The WADP's mission is to monitor market trends and issues that will have an impact on the philatelic business, analyze and disseminate information, improve knowledge of the philatelic markets, encourage and facilitate the adoption of best practices and distribute information relating to them. The 24th Congress mandated the POC to pursue dialogue with partners in the philately sector and coordinate philately development activities.

8 This association should therefore be reconstituted and provided with an effective Management Committee made up of external partners and issuing postal authorities with proven experience on the different continents, who wish to participate in WADP initiatives and activities.

IV. Development of the WNS (World Numbering System) and ways of combating illegal issues

9 The development of the system introduced on 1 January 2002 should continue in order to achieve ambitious and realistic objectives.

10 By the end of the 2009–2012 cycle, the system should have close to 200 members.

11 International philatelic exhibitions, meetings in Berne during the POC and CA sessions, philatelic forums, round tables and philatelic training workshops will all be used to seek new members.

12 Quality of service surveys and improvements to the website will be carried out annually.

13 The new membership leaflet will be updated and published in the six languages used at the International Bureau: Arabic, English, French, Portuguese, Russian and Spanish.

14 It will be emphasized that the WNS, originally formed to combat illegal issues, can also be a powerful promotional and sales tool when it links an issuing postal authority to an online shopping site.

15 The campaign against illegal issues, which were significantly reduced between 2005 and 2008, should continue, using two strategies:

– educating countries where this practice continues about the underlying reasons, ways of protecting themselves, and procedures for reporting illegal issues to the philatelic industry;

– continuing to disseminate to member countries UPU circulars exposing these issues. (However, reports will be checked more thoroughly and warning given of the consequences of unjustified reports.)

V. Promotion of the code of ethics and the status of the postage stamp

16 In resolution C 26/2008, the 24th Congress updated the code of ethics on philatelic issues.

17 A reminder of this code will be given at every philatelic workshop, forum or round table. A small booklet could also be published in several languages.

18 Article 8 of the UPU Convention, which gives the postage stamp its status, would also be included in this booklet.

19 A CD-Rom setting out the main principles of this code will be produced by the WADP Management Committee.

VI. Continuation of training

20 Training workshops modelled on the successful events held from 2005 to 2008 will continue.

21 A draft timetable is suggested below:

– 2009

- Training workshop for the countries of Asia-Pacific, which could be held during the China 2009 exhibition (April 2009).
- Training workshop for the countries of South America and the Caribbean: Argentina could be invited to host the event.

– 2010

- Training workshop for the countries of the Arab Permanent Postal Commission. Tunisia wishes to organize this event.
- Training workshop for the Russian-speaking countries and Asia Minor. Azerbaijan has offered to host this training session.

– 2011

- Training workshop for the countries of French-speaking Africa and English-speaking Africa (venue to be decided).
- Training workshop for the countries of Eastern Europe (venue to be decided).

– 2012

- Training workshop for the Portuguese-speaking countries (venue to be decided).

22 By spreading out the training in this way, at the rate of two sessions a year, it will be possible to cover every continent.

23 The themes of innovation, techniques for developing the philately market and the use of new technologies, as well as security techniques for the issue of postage stamps, will be developed by experts or countries with extensive experience in the relevant areas.

24 Sponsoring will be sought from our our WADP partners (IFSDA, ASCAT, AIJP, printers, etc.), and from issuing postal authorities from industrialized countries, in order to reduce organizing costs and the fee charged to each participant.

VII. Development of a training album for member countries (updating of TRAINPOST reference material)

25 The organization of training workshops as described in the previous point cannot address all the concerns of issuing postal authorities. A good way of meeting countries' expectations would be to produce a training album comprising high-quality presentations of learning material on a series of CD-Roms covering the full range of philatelic and postage stamp themes.

26 The following topics would be addressed in detail:

– developing a philatelic programme;

– contracts with artists, printers and agents;

– online selling;

– growing the domestic and international market;

– relations with partners (philatelic press, stamp dealers, catalogue editors, etc.);

– combating illegal issues;

– producing a successful joint issue;

– personalized postage stamp techniques;

– security perforations.

VIII. Developing software for Internet shopping

27 It emerged during the 2005–2008 cycle and in the training workshops that there was a real need for developing countries to be able to sell their postage stamps online.

28 In response to this need, expressed in resolution C 36/2008, a WADP project team should be tasked with drawing up specifications, seeking a designer, and implementing a trial.

IX. Forums and round tables

29 The policy of holding forums and round tables on key issues will continue.

30 These events should be held either during the POC/CA meetings in Berne, or in the course of major continental or international exhibitions.

31 Efforts will begin to find good internal and external presenters.

X. The work of the WADP distributed by project team

32 During the previous cycle, teamwork yielded good results; the continuation of this strategy during the next cycle could be considered.

33 The project teams for the 2009–2012 cycle could be as follows:

– PT 1: the philatelic press and Posts (AIJP, Posts);

– PT 2: philatelic exhibitions (FIP, International Bureau, Posts);

– PT 3: training programmes (International Bureau, Posts, INTERGRAF);

– PT 4: online shopping and designing software for developing countries (International Bureau, Posts, partners);

– PT 5: developing the philatelic market among young people (FIP, Posts, International Bureau);

– PT 6: market development and trends (Posts, partners, International Bureau).

34 Together, these teams cover the objectives set out in resolution C 36/2008.

XI. Involvement of external partners

35 The strengthening of links between Posts and external partners (AIJP, ASCAT, FIP, IFSDA, INTERGRAF) should be more evident.

36 The WADP should be a forum for constructive ideas aimed at making philately and interest in postage stamps more widespread. These ideas should be forward-looking, in order to reflect the tastes of the modern generation. Partners should become more involved in the work of the WADP; their presence at all the scheduled meetings is an essential part of the life of the WADP.

37 The objective of this philately development plan for 2009–2012 is to revitalize the market, particularly in countries where it has run out of steam.

XII. Conclusion

38 The Management Committee is asked to take note of and adopt this development plan.

Berne, 21 October 2008

K.J.S. McKEOWN

WADP Secretary